



PHOTOGRAPHS BY VINCENT ALBAN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Rhapsody in Orange and Blue
With the Knicks hosting their first N.B.A. finals since 1999, New Yorkers showed their colors at the Garden. More at nytimes.com.

Kim Fortifies North Korea, and His Own Control

By CHOE SANG-HUN
SEOUL — During the pandemic, the North Korean leader Kim Jong-un, who had long billed himself as invincible, made a stunning, teary-eyed apology on national television.
“I am really sorry,” he said, as the coronavirus, coupled with food shortages and international sanctions, was ravaging his country. “My efforts and sincerity have not been sufficient enough to rid our people of the difficulties in their life.”
But while ordinary North Koreans were suffering, Mr. Kim, 42, seized the crisis as a unique opportunity. Now, he is brimming with confidence. He is recognized at home and abroad as North Korea’s most powerful leader to date, surpassing even his grandfather, the country’s founder, because he has achieved the status of a de facto nuclear power.

From Covid-Era Crises to Crackdowns and a War Economy

He started during the pandemic by shutting down the border with China, issuing shoot-to-kill orders to stop North Koreans fleeing across the boundary. He clamped down on trade and smuggling across the border, forcing his people to rely less on imports and produce more goods domestically. His campaign also targeted the informal markets where many had eked out a living — trading Chinese goods and foreign entertainment smuggled in on thumb drives — ever since the devastating famine of the 1990s.
By dismantling these under-

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Quest to Find A ‘Deep State’ Creates Crises

By DEVLIN BARRETT
WASHINGTON — It was an investigation long sought by Kash Patel, the F.B.I. director, and it was announced not in court papers, but through a haze of cigar smoke on Joe Rogan’s podcast in early June of last year.
Mr. Patel’s prized criminal inquiry, known as “the grand conspiracy case,” sought to tie together actions by a group of people that President Trump blamed for various investigations into him, going back to the examination of possible ties between his 2016 campaign and Russia, and extending into events surrounding the 2020 election and the criminal prosecutions of Mr. Trump in 2023 and 2024. In the view of Mr. Trump and his supporters, there was a “deep state” cabal that had sought across multiple administrations and agencies to bring him down.
Mr. Patel told Mr. Rogan he had found a secret room of evidence inside F.B.I. headquarters confirming his long-held suspicions.
“You know how I caught these guys?” Mr. Patel asked. “Because these guys were so arrogant, they would write everything down, and I found the documents.”
To Mr. Patel, those documents, found in government burn bags — large brown paper bags with red and white stripes used to store papers designated for destruction — justified a sweeping investigation of former officials. To the former officials and the career investigators who looked at the evidence, the papers in the burn bags were nothing like a smoking gun. The administration’s efforts to find prosecutors willing to pursue such theories became a defining feature of the Trump administration’s politicization of the Justice Department — and the internal resistance to it.
New details of how that period unfolded show how Mr. Patel’s drive to target critics of the president set off cascading crises with U.S. attorneys’ offices, derailed distinguished careers and undercut the Justice Department’s credibility with judges. This account is based on interviews with multiple people with knowledge of the effort, all of whom requested anonymity because they were not authorized to speak publicly.
Asked for comment on this ac-

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LUIS ANTONIO ROJAS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Women who embroider Adidas apparel in Naupan, Mexico, say nothing is unfair about the work.

Cry of World Cup Exploitation Has Another Side

By JACK NICAS
NAUPAN, Mexico — It began as a feel-good story.
Someone Somewhere, a Mexican apparel company, posted online wondering why Mexico’s World Cup jerseys couldn’t be embroidered by some of the nation’s Indigenous artisans. It was an idea that could bridge Mexico’s past and present, the company argued, while lifting some of its most vulnerable out of poverty. The next day, Adidas called.
Last month, two years after that call, Adidas and Someone Somewhere unveiled versions of the Mexican national team jersey embroidered by hand by 150 Nahua women high in the mountains of central Mexico, in a tiny town called Naupan.
Adidas flew two of the artisans to Germany to induct the jerseys into a company archive. Someone Somewhere brought others onto the field for one of Mexico’s last friendly matches before the tournament starts this week. And the jerseys, despite costing more than \$200, sold fast.
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\$200 Jersey Stitched by Indigenous Artisans



NATIONAL A12-17, 20
Few Bids for Oil Leases
An auction to drill in a refuge in Alaska ended with little of the available land claimed for development. PAGE A15

Trump Nominates Blanche
The selection of Todd Blanche to lead the Justice Department could lead to a Senate confirmation fight. PAGE A20

INTERNATIONAL A4-10
Neo-Nazi Loses Mayoral Race
Despite his defeat in the runoff, his relative success capped a realization in Germany that voting for the far right is no longer considered taboo. PAGE A4

Pope and the Prime Minister
Leo and Pedro Sánchez of Spain, who met on Monday, have recently clashed with President Trump. PAGE A6

SPORTS B7-10
Ready for the World Cup Party
For some expat communities in New York, the long wait to see their team play is nearly over. PAGE B7



BUSINESS B1-6
Turmoil at ‘60 Minutes’
In an exclusive interview, Scott Pelley discussed the events that preceded his firing from CBS last week. PAGE B1

Central Ohio’s Transformation
Columbus has become a hub for manufacturing and tech, but not everyone is happy with the boom. PAGE B1

SCIENCE TIMES D1-8
Sharing a Slithery Fascination
In the Ecuadorian Amazon, a 101-year-old farmer and a young scientist turned an amateur collection of snakes into a scientific survey of one of the Earth’s most diverse habitats. PAGE D1

New Tech to Aid Rare Whales
Innovative systems to keep ships from hitting North Atlantic right whales are coming into use. The Trump administration is weighing whether they can replace a bedrock protection. PAGE D3

OPINION A18-19
Andrei Zakharov PAGE A18

THE WEATHER
Today, dry, sunny, high 82. Tonight, dry, partly cloudy, low 67. Tomorrow, partly sunny, a light breeze, a thunderstorm in spots in the afternoon, high 80. Weather map, Page A20.

After Exchange of Fire, Iran and Israel Placing Further Strikes on Hold

NEWS ANALYSIS For Israelis, Lesson on Limits of Power

By DAVID M. HALBFINGER
JERUSALEM — For Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel, the resumption of fighting with Iran on Sunday may have shown his supporters, at least momentarily, that he still was capable of standing up to President Trump.
But the halt to the fighting on Monday, after less than 15 hours, left Israel and its embattled leader in a bind and appearing as beholden to Mr. Trump as ever.
If Mr. Netanyahu had hopes of undermining the peace talks that Mr. Trump has been pursuing with Iran, the president’s pressure on both sides to stop the airstrikes — and Israel’s abandonment of preparations for another attack on Monday — showed this had failed.
The burst of warfare may have also altered how the warring parties weigh and respond to each new set of attacks — and not in a way that is advantageous for Israel.
Israel now understands that Iran can have its proxy army in Lebanon, Hezbollah, attack civilians in northern Israel, that Israeli counter-strikes at Hezbollah may prompt Iran to launch missiles at Israel and that Mr. Trump may prevent Israel from hitting back at Iran too hard or for too long.
“This was a major change,” said Raz Zimmt, director of the Iran program at the Institute for National Security Studies in Tel Aviv. He said it showed that Iran’s hard-line government was full of confidence and had concluded that “President Trump

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Warnings From Both Sides as U.S. Tries to Salvage Talks

This article is by Aaron Boxerman, Farnaz Fassihi, Ronen Bergman and Maggie Haberman.
Iran and Israel said on Monday that they were done with a round of attacks that briefly shattered a two-month cease-fire and threatened to push the Middle East back into full-blown war. Each country also warned that it stood ready to strike the other again.
Iran’s military said that it was stopping for now, after it fired ballistic missiles at Israel on Sunday in retaliation for an Israeli strike near the Lebanese capital, Beirut, against its ally Hezbollah. But the Iranian military said that if Israel resumed its “aggression and hostile acts,” including in southern Lebanon, which has been occupied by Israeli troops, “much harsher and more forceful actions than before will follow.”
Israel also pulled back on further attacks after it launched two waves of airstrikes across Iran, including against the country’s largest petrochemical complex, prompting further Iranian missile fire on central Israel.
Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel, at the urging of President Trump, instructed the Israeli military to halt preparations for another strike on Iran on Monday, according to two Israeli military officials who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive matters.
In a brief video message on Monday, Mr. Netanyahu confirmed that “fire is on hold” against Iran. He said Iran had tried to “force a new equation” by attacking Israel in retaliation for attacks on Hezbollah, the Iranian-

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SAMUEL GRANADOS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

The Doctor Will Be With You, After a Brief Consult With A.I.

By STEVE LOHR
Dr. Nicholas Gavin, an emergency medicine doctor at Mount Sinai in New York City, was working an overnight shift last summer when a patient came in with a puzzling set of symptoms. Within seconds, his three younger colleagues — two medical students and a resident — were consulting a free artificial-intelligence-powered app for physicians, OpenEvidence.
Dr. Gavin soon learned that they were far from outliers. A third of Mount Sinai’s 9,000 doctors were already regular OpenEvidence users, the health system’s executives found out in a meeting last year with the startup’s leaders.
“That was an ‘aha’ moment for our leadership,” said Dr. Gavin, who is also the system’s chief clinical innovation officer.
OpenEvidence’s A.I. app, essentially a chatbot for medicine, has become a viral hit with physicians. Talk to a doctor and chances are he or she uses the app to ask specific medical questions or bounce ideas off it in a diagnostic dialogue.
More than half of the nation’s

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ARTS C1-8
Standing Out at the Tonys
“Death of a Salesman” and “Schmigadoon!” (shown above) were big winners on Broadway’s biggest night. And Pink was a hit as the host. PAGE C1

